

Adjectives to describe characters

The best stories include unique characters. Use unusual adjectives to describe a character's mood and personality.



Tautologies

Some phrases say the same thing twice. These are called tautologies and should be avoided because they are unnecessary.

Tautology	Reason to avoid
tiny little baby	<i>Tiny</i> and <i>little</i> mean the same thing.
a round circle	Circles are always round.
an old antique	An antique has to be old.
an unexpected surprise	All surprises are unexpected.
yellow in color	Something can't be yellow in anything other than color.
month of May	May is always a month.
new innovation	An innovation has to be new.

Clichés

A cliché is a colloquial expression that has been overused. Clichés should be avoided because they make a piece of writing unoriginal, and because they are informal and often ambiguous.



Emotive language

Writers use emotive language to have a greater emotional impact on their audience. This technique is useful when trying to persuade or entertain an audience. It's important to be aware of the effect this language can have in order to analyze and write emotive texts.

Normal version	Dramatic version
she cried	she wailed
a good result	a staggering result
disturbance in town square	riot in town square
school fire	school blaze
brave person	heroic citizen
unhappy workers	furious workers
animals killed	animals slaughtered
house prices fall	house prices plummet
problems in schools	chaos in schools

Less wordy

Using more words than necessary can obscure the meaning of a phrase. Concise writing is both clearer and more stylish.

Wordy version	Concise version
a considerable number of	many
are of the same opinion	agree
as a means of	to
at the present time	currently, now, today
at this point in time	now
give an indication of	show
has a requirement for	requires, needs
has the ability to	can
in close proximity to	near
in the absence of	without
in the course of	during
in the majority of instances	usually
in the very near future	soon
is aware of the fact	knows